TECHNOLOGY AND THE HUMAN PERSON IN THE AGE OF AI
Baylor Symposium on Faith and Culture
Baylor University
February 26–28, 2026

Thursday, February 26

8:30 a.m.

Check-In Table Opens (George W. Truett Theological Seminary, Entrance Lobby)

9:00 to 10:30 a.m.

Sessions at George W. Truett Theological Seminary

Don't Worry Artists: AI Can't Worship
- Matthew Aughtry, Baylor University
- Carla Neuss, Baylor University
- Sean Oswald, University of Mary Hardin Baylor
- Daniel Hill, Baylor University
- Chair: Deanna Toten Beard

Baylor Law Panel: Leadership as Vocation: Forming Virtuous Professionals in a Time of Technological Transformation
- Leah Teague, Baylor University

AI's Expanding Horizon: Cultural, Ethical, and Human Challenges
- Can Humans Flourish in the New AI Cult? A Comparison of Big Tech AI, Greek Goddess Cults, and Old Testament Prophecy
  —Jonathan Gerber, Independent Scholar
- AI as Social Gamebreaker
  —Robert Reed, Baylor University
- What is Public Health for? Artificial Intelligence, Wendell Berry, and Healing in the Age of the Machine
  —Karl Johnson, University of North Carolina
  —David Tillman, Cambell University
- Chair: Nathern Okilwa

Being and Bots: Heidegger, Film, and the Meaning of AI
- Android Aloneness? Exploring the Possibility of Robot Emotions
  —Paul Carron, Baylor University
- Biology, Being, and Bringing-Forth: Making Heidegger Analytic
  —Lucas Merritt, Baylor University
- Chair: Ezra Choe

Sessions at Bill Daniel Student Center

Educating for Insight in the Age of AI: Across the Disciplines

- Ian Gravagne, Baylor University
- Blake Allan, Baylor University
- Phil Donnelly, Baylor University
- Chair: Jill Patterson

Healthcare for Humans in the Age of AI

- Lauren Barron, Baylor University
- Ashley Barrett, Baylor University
- Kelly Nieves, Waco Family Medicine
- Forest Kim, Baylor University
- Pablo Rivas, Baylor University
- Chair: James Henderson

The Ethics of Digital Fieldwork: AI in Qualitative and Ethnographic Research

- The Implications and Ethics of Qualitative Research and AI
  —Sarah Harris, Baylor University
- Spirit, Self, and Machine: Theological Reflections on AI-Assisted Ethnography in a Zomi Pentecostal Context
  —Thang San Mung, Canaan Mission Church
- Assessing the True Human Impact of AI Transcription
  —Steven Sielaff, Baylor University Institute for Oral History

Detection, Design, and Human Writing in the AI Era

- Canaries in the AI: A Simple and Versatile Method for the Detection and Prevention of Generative AI Use in Online Assessments
  —Christina Hitchcock, University of Sioux Falls
- Not All is Lost: Crafting and Scaffolding Writing Assignments Across Disciplines in the Midst of Faulty AI Detection
  —Kelli Cummings, Taylor University
- Once More, with Feeling: Reviving Our Appeals for Human Reading and Writing in the Age of AI
  —Robert Brown, Baylor University
- Chair: Saralyn McKinnon-Crowley

Crane Scholars Program Panel

- Efficiency: Death of Culture
  —Garrett Vickers, Baylor University
- A Lamp-Like Sun: The Necessity of a Theology Ontology in the Age of AI
  —Zachary Miyazaki, Baylor University

11:00 a.m. to 12:00 p.m.

Lunch

12:00 to 1:30 p.m.

Sessions at George W. Truett Theological Seminary

The Sacred Struggle: AI in Preaching and Worship

- Woe to Me as I Try to Preach the Gospel: The Role of Struggle in Human vs. AI Preaching
  —Alison Gerber, Baylor University
- Silicon in the Sanctuary: Leveraging Artificial Intelligence in Worship Planning
  —John Cornish, Alliance Methodist Church, Fort Worth, Texas
- Revelation and Response as Input and Generate: AI and the Worship of God
  —Robert Pendergraft, University of Mary Hardin-Baylor

AI in Legal Practice

- Artificial Intelligence, Personal Injury Law, and Art of Attorney-Client Relationships
  —James Marcum, Baylor University
  —Vic Feazell, Law Offices of Vic Feazell
- Made in the Image of God, AI-Assisted Crime, and Legal Responsibility
  —Naomi Goodno, Pepperdine University

The Sacred Difference: Imago Dei in the Age of Algorithms

- Image Bearers and Intelligent Machines: Stewarding AI for Human Flourishing
  —Robert DeVargas, Dallas Baptist University; Eternal Interactive, Inc.
- The Imago Dei: The Impossibility of Artificial General Intelligence (AGI) and the Replication of Human Agency
  —Finney Premkumar, University of Birmingham
- Holistic Dualism and Shared Self: Doing Theological Anthropology in the Age of AI and VR
  —John Paul Arceno, Southwestern Baptist Theological Seminary

Undergraduate Panel: The Limits of Artificial Intelligence

- Brent Gibson, University of Mary Hardin-Baylor

Sessions at Bill Daniel Student Center

AI and Relationships in Workplace and Communities

- AI, Work, and Worth: A Faith-Informed Framework for Ethical and Compliant AI in the Workplace
  —Tami Nutt, Aspect43
- Cognitive Modeling of Christian Communities: Developing Intelligent Agents to Address the Polarization Effects in Churches
  —Eric Araújo, Calvin University
- Chair: Tiffany Flood

AI in the Caring Professions: Forming Practitioners for Human Flourishing

- From Skeptic to Strategist: AI's Place in Social Work Education
  —Sylvia Bekele, Eastern University
- Preparing Healthcare Students for Ethical Generative AI Use: A Framework Grounded in Technology Theory and Human Flourishing
  —Bridget Scheidler, Baylor University
- Prompt Engineering and Parallel Charts: New Narrative Medicine in the Age of AI
  —Julianna Leachman, Houston Christian University
- Chair: Michele Stover

Healing Hands, Digital Tools: AI in Medical Practice

- Artificial Intelligence and the Human Person in Medical Practice: A Philosophical-Anthropological Critique
  —Juan Fabregat, FinMedica by TecSalud, Mexico
- What do we Know about How Generative AI is Being Used for Patient-centered Communication? A Scoping Review
  —Ashley Barrett, Baylor University
- Exploring AI Use in Christian Community Health Ministry
  —Erin Ervin, University of Southern Maine; Faulkner University
- Chair: Renee Flippo

Mental Health, Wellbeing, Community

- AI Can't Mediate a Relationship with God
  —Heidi Vogeler, Brigham Young University
  —Emma Meyers, Brigham Young University
  —Rylee Hopkins, Brigham Young University
- Presence and Personhood: AI, Self-Therapy, and Spiritual Direction
  —Gavin Ostertag, Baylor University
- Sacred Slop: How Generative AI Mediates Meaning-Making and Community Formation in Digital Mormonism
  —Spencer Stewart, Purdue University
- Chair: Hyunsoo Yoo

Theological Reflection on Art + Creativity

- AI-Produced Art... and Imaginations: The Beginnings of a Theological Exploration
  —Anna Grace Galkin, University of St. Andrews, St. Mary's College
- AI, Consciousness, and Creativity
  —Logan Wigglesworth, Auburn University
- In the Image of a Maker God: Generative AI and Human Creativity
  —Shannon Valenzuela, University of Dallas
- Chair: Meagan Soltwisch

Leading the AI Transition: From Hesitation to Innovation

- A Higher Calling: A Christian Elevation of AI Ethics
  —Clark Cully, Indiana Wesleyan University
- Scaling Artificial Intelligence in Education
  —Curtis Isozaki, Baylor University
  —Jacob Sands, Pepperdine University
- Moving Faculty from AI Reticent to AI Innovative
  —Amy Harriton, Fellowship Christian School
- Chair: Abigail Gamble

Frameworks for AI Governance and Evaluation

- Introducing the Flourishing AI Benchmark: A New Standard for Human-Centric AI Evaluation
  —Nicholas Skytland, Gloo
- Trustworthy AI Begins Here: NIST's Risk Framework and Public Safeguards
  —Leonard Wills, NAES Corporation; Freelance Consultant
- A Framework for Considering AI in Safety-Critical Systems
  —Christopher Mikulski, U.S. Army DEVCOM Ground Vehicle Systems Center

1:30 to 2:00 p.m.

Break

2:00 to 3:30 p.m.

Featured Sessions

From Algorithms to Virtues: AI and Formation

- The Metaphor is the Message: How we Describe our Machines Shapes What They Become
  —Josh Brake, Harvey Mudd College
- Design Norms and Virtues for Artificial Intelligence
  —Derek Schuurman, Calvin University
- Can AI Have a Role in Spiritual Formation?
  —Harry Plantinga, Calvin University
- Chair: Larry Parsley

Faith-Driven Perspectives from Silicon Valley's AI Frontier

- Ron Ivey, Harvard University
- Matthew Iselin, OpenAI
- Ben Bajarin, Creative Strategies
- Erik Ellefsen, Baylor University

DELTA: A Faith-Based Framework for Discerning the Role of AI in Schools, Churches, and Life (NetVUE Hosted)

- Adam Kronk, University of Notre Dame
- Julia French, University of Notre Dame

AI at Baylor

- Messing with our Minds? Neurotechnologies, AI, and Christian Ethics
  —Neil Messer, Baylor University
- AI, Decision Making, and Moral Responsibility
  —Yulia Sullivan, Baylor University
- Teaching Integrity and Judgement in the Use of Artificial Intelligence in Professional Legal Education`
  —Matthew Cordon, Baylor University
  —Elizabeth Fraley, Baylor University
- Chair: Gary Carini

AI and Media

- A Journalist's Blueprint for AI and Christianity
  —Ryan Struyk, CNN
- Title TBD
  —Lee C. Camp, *No Small Endeavor*

3:30 to 4:00 p.m.

Break

4:00 to 5:30 p.m.

Undergraduate Student Social (Truett Seminary Room 309)

Sessions at George W. Truett Theological Seminary

Parenting, Children, and Formation in the Age of AI

- The Screentime Letters
  —Robert Garcia, Baylor University
- The AI-Empowered Parent: Raising Humans in the AI Age
  —Sarah Dooley, AI-Empowered Mom, LLC
- Raising Children in the Age of AI: Worldview Formation in a Digital Age
  —Jessica Peck, Baylor University
- Chair: Meagan Soltwisch

Embodied, Embedded, and Limited: What We Teach Machines

- Embodied Persons, Disembodied Code: An Interdisciplinary Engagement with AI
  —Changin Sohn, Graduate Theological Union – Center for Theology and the Natural Sciences
- The Human Ceiling: Inferring AI's Limitations from the Limits of Humanity
  —Joshua Smith, Baylor University
- The Newest Mirror: Artificial Intelligence, Human Self-Concept, and Christian Humility
  —Sam Hawkins, University of Louisiana Monroe

The Poet, the Pope, and the Robot

- The Poet, the Statesman, and the Robot
  —Mike Ortiz, Baylor University
- Artificial, Human, and Relational Intelligence: Insights from Antiqua et Nova
  —Joyce Konigsburg, DePaul University
- Chair: James Bennighof

Universities in Transition: Flourishing in an AI Environment

- Grounded in Human-Centered Values and Servant Leadership Virtues: A Conceptual Framework for Assignment Redesign in the Age of AI
  —Tanya Tarbutton, Concordia University Irvine
  —Lori Doyle, Concordia University Irvine
  —Yvette Stuewe, Concordia University Irvine
- Interplay: A Diagnostic Platform to Help Universities Flourish in the Age of AI
  —Nicole Haddad, Southern Methodist University
- The Learning Journey Reimagined: Inviting Human Presence and Wisdom into the AI Conversation
  —Adam Wilson, Lipscomb University
  —Jennifer Shewmaker, Lipscomb University
  —Laura Morrow, Lipscomb University

Sessions at Bill Daniel Student Center

AI in K–12 Education: Wisdom, Formation, and Learning

- Navigating the AI Landscape with Students: Using Purpose, Agency, and Learning (PAL) to Orient Us
  —Deborah Van Duinen, Hope College
- Artificial Intelligence and Children's Intelligence
  —MaryAnn Seng, Concordia University – Irvine

AI and the Moral Edges of Medicine

- Character in Conflict: Technology and the Human Person in Modern Military Medicine
  —Jon Butler, Baylor University
- Can AI Think Ethically? Evaluating AI's Ability to Make Medical Ethical Decisions
  —Amber Zimmerman, Loma Linda University
- Artificial Intelligence and Moral Deliberation in Medical Ethics
  —Alex Nelson, Loma Linda University
- Chair: Michele Stover

Artistic and Artificial Intelligence: An AI2 Vision of the Future

- Mike Fernandez, Lipscomb University
- Steve Nordstrom, Lipscomb University
- Todd McCullough, Lipscomb University
- Sarah Gibson, Lipscomb University
- Chair: Elise King

Algorithm and Altar: Charting a Faithful Course for Generative AI

- Scott Hamm, Abilene Christian University
- Mike Willoughby, Abilene Christian University
- Vic McCracken, Abilene Christian University
- Claire Davidson Frederick, Abilene Christian University

"Words Without Thoughts Never to Heaven Go": Virtue and the Writing Classroom after AI

- Zsanna Mária Bodor, Baylor University
- Matthew Turnbull, Colorado Christian University
- Daniel Crouch, Harding University
- Andrew Hicks, Calvin College
- Chair: Jason Pitts

Political Life in an Algorithmic Age

- Deep Faith: Politics, Religion, and the Language of Algorithms
  —Mostafa Amini, Harvard University
  —Anwar Ouassini, Delaware State University
- From Virtue to Power: The Rise and Role of Generative AI in Postmodern Politics
  —Samuel Chen, Northampton Community College/The Liddell Group

AI, Personhood, and the Meaning of Being Human

- Artificial General Intelligence and the Transcendent Singularity of the Human Person
  —Charles McDaniel, Baylor University
- Preserving Our Humanity in an AI World
  —Randy Ridenour, Oklahoma Baptist University
- Is AI a Threat to Human Value?
  —Eric Sotnak, The University of Akron

5:30 to 6:00 p.m.

Break

6:00 to 6:45 p.m.

Dinner (Cashion 5th Floor)

6:45 to 8:15 p.m.

Welcome (Cashion 5th Floor)

- Elisabeth Rain Kincaid, Director of Baylor University Institute for Faith and Learning

Plenary Address (Cashion 5th Floor)

- Elaine Howard Ecklund, Rice University

Friday, February 27

9:00 to 10:30 a.m.

Sessions (George W. Truett Theological Seminary)

Undergraduate Presentations: Human Uniqueness Ethics and AI
- Formed to Respond: AI, Answerability, and the Moral Shape of the Human Person
  —Lucy Meurer, Union University
- Man-Eating Machine: How AI Overreliance Poses a Threat to Human Identity
  —Lillian McCulloch, Taylor University
- Chair: Savannah Landerholm

Athletic Directors Roundtable: Navigating the Changing Landscape of College Athletics
- Kenny Boyd, Baylor University
- Bethany Miller, Biola University
- Tim Sceggel, LeTourneau University
- Chair: Paul Putz, Baylor University

Education, Ethics, and Spiritual Formation
- A Tour of the Head, the Heart, and the Hands that Teach with Artificial Intelligence
  —Dane C. Joseph, George Fox University
- Technology, Transcendence, and Temptation: A Call for Cultivating Spiritual Literacy
  —Clark Cully, Indiana Wesleyan University
  —Uday Balasundaram, Indiana Wesleyan University
  —Joshua Nwokeji, Indiana Wesleyan University
- Fruit Trees and Search Trees: Towards an Augustinian Model for AI Ethics
  —Mathew Scruggs, St. Edward's University
  —Soleil Thallemer, St. Edward's University
- Chair: Nathern Okilwa

Aquinas in the Age of AI
- Would Aquinas Use ChatGPT?: Aquinas on Technology and Human Flourishing
  —Donnie DeBord, Freed-Hardeman University
- A Thomistic Understanding of Artificial Intelligence and the Divine Intellect
  —Timothy Sutton, Samford University
- The Aesthetic and Ethical Implications of "Artificial Creativity" through a Thomistic Lens
  —Nicole Darcy, Holy Apostles College & Seminary

Beyond the Human: Dehumanization, Posthuman Futures, and the AI Church
- Resisting a Posthuman Future
  —C. Ben Mitchell, Union University
- AI, OI (Organoid Intelligence), and Ersatz Incarnation: The Cybernetic Roots of the De-humanization of Thinking
  —Kimbell Kornu, Belmont University
- The AI Church
  —Robert Marks, Baylor University

Plato, Technology, and the Philosophical Imagination

- Craft and Imitation: A Platonic Taxonomy of Artificial Intelligence
  —Matthew Newell, Academy of the Holy Cross
- Plato Against Socrates on AI
  —Gary Hartenburg, Houston Christian University
- The Consolation of the Philosophy of Technology: Fighting AI-Related Fear and Fatigue with Historical Perspectives from Plato to Postman
  —Emily Stelzer, Houston Christian University

Dignity, Law, and AI: Catholic Social Teaching

- Artificial Intelligence and the Affront to Dignity: Catholic Social Teaching in Context,
  —Chris Chambers Goodman, Pepperdine University
- Love, Dignity, and the Artificial Other: AI Sexbots and the Boundaries of Human Identity in Law, Ethics, and Work
  —Kevin Jackson, Fordham University
- Of New Matters: Reflections on AI in the Workplace and Rerum Novarum
  —Emmy (Edwards) Walters, Perkins Coie LLP

Scripture, Spirits, and Systems: Biblical Discernment in an AI Age

- Faith Integration and Formation in Theological Education during an Age of AI: A Biblical and Theological Reassessment
  —Kaz Hayashi, Bethel University
- Spirits of the Air: Patristic Wisdom for a Disincarnate Age
  —Thomas Harmon, University of St. Thomas, Houston

Pastoral Ministry in a Digital Age

- Discipleship in the Age of Artificial Intelligence: Reimagining Ecclesial Formation with AI
  —Hermas Lo, International School of Christian Education
- Not Alone in the Study: Emotional Presence, Theological Integrity, and the Communal Use of AI in Pastoral Leadership
  —Nick Martineau, Hope Community Church
- "My Pastor is a Robot!": Functionalism and Ontology in Word and Sacrament
  —Thomas Pearson, University of Texas Rio Grande Valley

Forming "Generation AI": Wisdom, Character, and Classroom Practice

- Generation AI: Preparing for the First AI-Native Students and Building a Post-AI Classroom
  —Sarah Gibson, Lipscomb University
  —Katey Earls, Battle Creek High School
  —Emily Gibson, Lipscomb Academy
- The Use of AI to Enhance Inclusivity within Diverse Learning Environments
  —Sara Morgan, Concordia University Irvine
  —Catherine Webb, Concordia University Irvine

Teaching STEM Students: Character, Competence, and Creativity with AI

- ChatGPT and the Crisis of Dominion: Virtue, Limits, and the Moral Shape of the Human Person
  —Jonathan Lett, LeTourneau University
- Maintaining Relevance of Freshman Engineering Students in the Era of Artificial Intelligence, Foretold by Isaac Asimov
  —Amber Johnson, LeTourneau University
  —John Tixier, LeTourneau University
  —Andrew Davis, LeTourneau University
- Forming T-Shaped Engineers in the Age of AI: A Roadmap for Christian Education and Human Flourishing
  —Michael McGinnis, LeTourneau University
- Chair: Jason Pitts

Composition, LLMs, and the Christian Mind

- Ryan Sinni, LeTourneau University
- Luke Brake, Sterling College
- Brent Pinkall, New Saint Andrews College

AI and Holistic Faculty Development

- Elizabeth Stice, Palm Beach Atlantic University
- Cynthia Wells, Messiah University
- Jan Harris, Lipscomb University
- Kristina Pazehoski, Grove City College
- Ana Jaramillo de Graham, Palm Beach Atlantic University

10:30 to 10:45 a.m.

Break

10:45 a.m. to 12:15 p.m.

Sessions (George W. Truett Theological Seminary)

Student Panel on AI and University Learning Policies

- Jacob West, Hardin-Simmons University
- Jonathan Durance, Hardin-Simmons University
- Aaron Pardue, Hardin-Simmons University

Stewardship and Systems in an Age of Economy

- Future Foresight: Faith-Inspired Stewardship in the Age of AI – How Artificial Intelligence is Reshaping Estate and Tax Planning
  —Erin Hill, Jessup University
  —Manuel Salazar, Charleston Southern University
- From Calculator to Co-Participant: Reimagining AI in the Accounting Profession
  —Marty Stuebs, Baylor University
  —James Marcum, Baylor University
  —Robert Ewing, New Mexico State University
- Artificial Intelligence and a Professor's Search for Meaning
  —Gia Chevis, Baylor University
- Chair: Marilyn Rhames

Embodied Longing: Presence, Telepresence, and What AI Cannot Give

- Extraordinary Technology and Ordinary Life
  —Brent Waters, Garrett-Evangelical Theological Seminary
- The Presence of AI: Presence, Telepresence, or Omnipresence?
  —Douglas Estes, New College of Florida
- Will a Subscription Really Give Me What I Crave? Examples of Embodied Friendship in Literature and Life
  —Katherine Wyma, Anderson University

"My weaknesses are my Strengths": Addressing AI through Theological, Neurological, and Technocratic Critiques

- Christopher Krall, Creighton University
- Kristen Drahos, Baylor University
- Moderator: Brian Boyd, Future of Life Institute
- Chair: Heather Hudson

Rooted and Ready: Faith-Informed AI Literacy for Human Flourishing in K–12 Communities

- Kristin Collette, Baylor University
- Dale Rush, Lake Lure Classical Academy

Seeing Clearly in an Over-Informed World

- Synthetic Omniscience: Discerning the Spirit in a World That Knows Everything but Understands Nothing
  —Joshua Jonas, Baylor University
  —Rolando Lewis
- *The Labyrinth of the World*, John Amos Comenius's 400-Year-Old Guide to Seeing Clearly in an AI World
  —Bill Robinson, Independent Scholar
- Sophomoric Harm and Its Implications for AI
  —David Bibighaus, Messiah University

Personhood Under Challenge: AI and Theological Anthropology

- "But Could It Be a Person?": An Apophatic Anthropology in the Age of AI
  —Austin Spiller, Southeastern University
- Cultivating Love in a Multicultural Society: Moral Formation, AI, and Herman Bavinck's Theological Anthropology
  —Devon Goings, Fuller Theological Seminary
- Artificial Intelligence and the End of Theological Anthropology
  —Fidel Arnecillo, California State University, San Bernardino

Disability Theology

- Disability, Debility, and the Production of AI: Towards a Christian Ethic of Flourishing Now
  —Calli Micale, Eastern University
- Reclaiming Intelligence: AI, Disability, and the Embodied Eucharist
  —Lindsey Gibson, University of Aberdeen

Formation, Teaching, and Technology in an AI World

- A Call for Religious Education on AI: How Humanity's Unique Role as the Image Bearers of God Challenges Higher Education to Reimagine Pedagogical Practices
  —Trevor Hodges, Regent University
- Preserving Human Flourishing in an AI World
  —Justin Gandy, Dallas Baptist University
  —Mary Flickner, Dallas Baptist University
- Creativity Inspiring Technology: Responsible AI as Catalyst for Spiritual Formation and Theological Education
  —Uday Balasundaram, Indiana Wesleyan University

Formed by Machines: Imagination, Community, and Character

- How to Be Human in the Age of AI: A Trinitarian Framework for Embodied Disciples in the Era of LLMs
  —Chris Hope, Boston University
- Wise Use of AI: Safeguarding the Human Person in Faith Communities
  —Heidi Vogeler, Brigham Young University
  —Samara Rangel, Brigham Young University
  —Anna Smith, Brigham Young University
- Artificial Intelligence in Light of a Theology of the Cross Reflecting the Philosophy of George Grant and Simone Weil
  —Jeffrey McPherson, Roberts Wesleyan University

How AI Shapes Us

- Do Androids Eat at Electric Feasts? Technology, Community, and Higher Education
  —Philip Byers, Taylor University
- Patterns of Knowing: The Effect of AI on the Imagination
  —Jacob Carr, Oklahoma Christian University
- Technology, Practice, and Character: AI in Education
  —Christopher Richmann, Baylor University

Teaching for Depth: Classroom Practices in the Age of Generative AI

- Critical Thinking in the Age of Generative AI
  —Amy Emanuel, Christian Heritage College, Brisbane Australia
  —Craig Murison, Christian Heritage College, Brisbane Australia
- Moral Formation and A(I)nthropocenic Imagination; Reflecting on Undergraduate Bioethics Pedagogy
  —Leah Lomotey-Nakon, Baylor University
- Can I Just Read a Summary? Generative AI and its Effects on Reading and Knowledge
  —Aimee Callender, Wheaton College
- Chair: Chelsea Sentell

The Institutional AI Playbook: A Grassroots Approach to Shifting Mindsets and Achieving Faculty Buy-In

- Jennifer Shewmaker, Lipscomb University
- Sarah Gibson, Lipscomb University
- Laura Morrow, Lipscomb University
- Adam Wilson, Lipscomb University

Reflections on Science Fiction, Theology, and AI

- Toward a Theology of Artificial Intelligence in the Fiction of Will D. Campbell
  —Doug Campbell, University of North Texas
- Man as the Measure: Reckoning with the Real in E.M. Forster's "The Machine Stops"
  —Molly Lewis, Regent University
- Living in anthropological exile: AI, "The Machine Stops," and the imperatives of 1 Peter
  —Preston Cosgrove, Concordia University Wisconsin

12:30 to 1:30 p.m.

Lunch

1:45 to 3:15 p.m.

Sessions (George W. Truett Theological Seminary)

The Intersection of Human and Machine: Undergraduate and Faculty Perspectives

- AI Opportunities: Productive or Superficial Learning
  —Emily Tracy, Montreat College
- Human Fragmentation and the Rise of AI As Human
  —Mark Blalock, Montreat College
  —Jesse Kramer, Montreat College
- Identifying Links in AI Dependency and Creative Beliefs
  —Sidney Hartness, Montreat College
- AI and the Tertiary Imagination
  —Zachary Rhone, Montreat College
  —Thomas Hill, Montreat College

Beyond Optimization: Character Formation and the Student-Athlete in the Age of AI

- Adam Stanley, Baylor University
- Erin Tarver, Emory University
- Sean Strehlow, Messiah University
- Chair: Paul Putz, Baylor University

When the Machine "Gets" Me: Empathy, Intimacy, and AI

- It Gets Me: The Sin of AI Empathy
  —Margaret Diddams, Christian Scholar's Review
- AI Companions and the Reshaping of Human Connection and Intimacy
  —William Struthers, Wheaton College
- The Consciousness Eclipse: Why Not Bond with ChatGPT?
  —Nate Otey, Boston Trinity Academy
- Chair: Julia Hejduk

Vocation and the Future: Teaching Connectedness

- Vocation, Higher Education, and the Future
  —Erin VanLaningham, NetVUE
- Called to Kinship: Teaching Interdependence in a Culture of Fear
  —Justin Klassen, Bellarmine University
- AI, Technology, and Hope: Innovating Vocation for the Future
  —Meghan Winchell, Nebraska Wesleyan University
- Environmental Justice: Called to Care for Our Common Home
  —Mari Elise Ewing, Austin College
- Chair: Chelsea Sentell

Working with Machines: How AI Reshapes Culture, Care, and Organizational Life

- Culture by Code: What Happens When Machines Shape Our Norms?
  —Julia Wiener, Indiana Wesleyan University / JW Strategies, LLC
- Boundary Spanning at the Crossroads of Technology and Humanity: The Manager's Role in Shaping AI Companionship
  —Hope Koch, Baylor University
  —Min Ou, Baylor University
  —Qin Weng, Baylor University
- Affordance of Care: Practical AI Implications for Public Relations
  —Morgan van den Berg, Michigan State University
  —Abbey Ross, Michigan State University
- Chair: Sophia Zhang

Disability and AI: Human Limitation, Imagination, and Hope

- Once Upon a Time, in a Wheelchair Far Far Away: Analyzing AI-Generated Stories About Disability
  —Katherine (Kate) Rojales, Baylor University
  —Madi Snow-Gould, Baylor University
- Eliminating Disability? Brain-Computer Interfaces and the Future of Human Limitation
  —Jackson McNeece, Baylor University
- Exploring the Role of AI in Restoring Prayer in Aphasia: A Case Study Proposal for Mild Aphasia
  —Hyunsoo Yoo, Baylor University

Scriptural Reflections on Technology

- New Jerusalem or New Babylon? The Tower of Babel's Challenge to Utopian Claims and Theosis Goals of Collective Human Technologies
  —Michael Whiting, Dallas Baptist University
  —Mark Cook, Dallas Baptist University
  —Blake Killingsworth, Dallas Baptist University
- From Cain to the Cloud: Human Nature and the Ethics of Technology in Genesis 4-11
  —Andrew Borror, North Carolina Study Center

Algorithmic Oppression: Race, Power, and AI

- The Algorithmic Pantheon: Who AI Tells Us to Admire and What That Reveals About Us
  —Abdullah Shahid, Wingstop, University of Tubingen
  —Nazia Shahid, SmartGen LLC
- Part Person, Part Tool: How AI Users Adopt the Slaveholder's Mindset
  —Danielle Miller, Baylor University
- Afrofuturists Theologies as Resistance to Algorithmic Oppression
  —Ashton Alexander, University of Memphis

The Sacred Value of Imperfection: Bodies, Identity, and Spiritual Uncertainty

- Images, Information, and AI: The Body as Moral Terrain and the Human Person
  —Megan Heeder, University of Scranton
- Becoming UnDone: Faith, Identity, and the Cost of Optimization in the Age of AI
  —Toby Brooks, Baylor University
- Artificial Intelligence and the Good of Spiritual Uncertainty
  —Christina George, Biola University

Proceed with Caution: Recognizing Challenges in Education

- Reflections on a Year of Slow Learning in the Age of AI
  —Elizabeth Parker, Asbury University
- Human Expression: A Dying Currency in the Age of AI
  —Nathan Weflen, Calvin University
- Educational Achievement and AI: A Case for AI Avoidance
  —Kirsten Welch, Baylor University

Psychological and Spiritual Dimensions of AI and Mental Health

- Digital Technology and Artificial Intelligence: A Psychological, Socio-Cultural, and Spiritual Perspective
  —Naji Abi-Hashem, Baylor University; Duke University
- The Fall, the Rise, and the Redemption: AI and Examen on Post-Traumatic Stress and Suicidal Ideation
  —Augustin Callini, Creighton University
  —Christian Hu, Creighton University
  —Mariska Suwanda, Creighton University
  —Fr. Christopher Krall, SJ, Creighton University

Writing with Machines, Centering the Human: GenAI Pedagogy Across San Antonio's Hispanic-Serving Institutions

- Jamie Crosswhite, St. Mary's University
- Nicole López, St. Mary's University
- Sue Hum, University of Texas at San Antonio
- Jennifer Keizer, University of Texas at San Antonio

Cheating, Community, and Care: Rethinking AI Policies

- Unpacking Institutional AI Policies: Examination through Sociocultural and Ethical Lenses
  —Jean Kiekel, University of St. Thomas
  —Matthew Panozzo, University of Memphis
- If Everyone Is Cheating: The Collision of AI Policy and Practice at a Christian University
  —Brian Doak, George Fox University
  —Mary Peterson, George Fox University
- AI and the Small Christian College Learning Community
  —John Fry, Trinity Christian College

Against Efficiency: Leisure, Time, and Human Flourishing

- The Importance of Being Earnest – Cultivating Inwardness in the Digital Age
  —Alejandro Tamez, University of Kansas
- The Case against Efficiency: Josef Pieper and Kurt Vonnegut on the Forgotten Virtue of Leisure
  —Gabriel Torretta, Providence College
- Virtue against Rapidification: Stewardship of Time in a World Accelerated by AI
  —Mariele Courtois, Benedictine College
- Chair: Ezra Choe

Concerning the Spiritual in AI and Art

- Henrik Söderström, Indiana Wesleyan University
- Luke Anspach, Anderson University, South Carolina
- Zac Benson, Anderson University, South Carolina
- Chair: Jer Nelsen, Anderson University, South Carolina

3:15 to 3:30 p.m.

Break

3:30 to 5:00 p.m.

Featured Sessions (George W. Truett Theological Seminary)

AI, Education, and Formation

- The Role of the Spiritual Imagination in the "Nurturing" of AI
  —David Kim, Goldenwood
- A Toolkit for Ethical Decision-Making in the Age of AI
  —Nathan King, Whitworth University
- Title TBD
  —David Wood, Brigham Young University

Human Voices Amid Machine Words
- Rachel Griffis, Spring Arbor University
- Richard Gibson, Wheaton College
- Jeffrey Bilbro, Grove City College & Front Porch Republic

Catholic Moral Theology and the Challenges of AI.
- Has the Catholic Position on Technological Neutrality Changed with Artificial Intelligence?
  —Alejo José G. Sison, University of Navarre
  —Elisabeth Rain Kincaid, Baylor University
- The Workbench and the Idol: Learning from Pope St. John Paul II to Keep the Future Human
  —Brian Boyd, Future of Life Institute
- Title TBD
  —Joseph Vukov, Loyola University Chicago

AI and Flourishing
- Matthew Lee, Baylor University
- Matt Wilson, Baylor University
- Byron Johnson, Baylor University

AI, Bioethics, and the Nature of the Human Person
- Jeffrey Bishop, Saint Louis University
- Gerald McKenny, University of Notre Dame
- Devan Stahl, Baylor University
- Chair: Emilie Cunningham

5:30 to 6:00 p.m.

Vespers (Paul W. Powell Chapel, George W. Truett Theological Seminary)

6:15 to 7:15 p.m.

Dinner (Cashion 5th Floor)

7:15 to 8:30 p.m.

Plenary Address (Cashion 5th Floor)
- Andy Crouch, Praxis

Chair—Matthew Lee, Baylor University

Saturday, February 28

9:00 to 10:30 a.m.

Sessions (George W. Truett Theological Seminary)

John Brown University Undergraduate Panel

- The Art of Medicine: Consciousness, the Creative Process, and the Integration of AI
  —Makenna Lamb, John Brown University
- Is a Bare Intelligence Possible? The Ethics of AI and Truth's Connection to Goodness and Beauty
  —Joshua Freeman, John Brown University
- Martin Buber's *I and Thou* as a Lens for the Ground of Being and Artificial Identity
  —Reagan Cartmill, John Brown University

Chair: Ryan Butler, John Brown University

Mind and Machine: Outsourcing, Extension, and the Illative Sense

- The Epistemic Value of Outsourcing to AI
  —Matt Matherne, St. Edward's University
- Computational thinking, Artificial Intelligence, and the Extended Mind: Strategies for Understanding the Future of the Interface between Human Cognition and Computation
  —James Van Slyke, Fresno Pacific University
- Newman, AI, and the Illative Sense
  —Bryan Williams, CSC, Fordham University
- Chair: Jason Whitt

When Artificial Code Mirrors God's Image: Toward a Post-Anthropocentric Imago Dei

- Ray Umphrey, University of the Cumberlands
- Jonathan Hernandez, Southern Baptist Theological Seminary
- Jesse Roberts, Tennessee Tech University

Impersonation vs. Personhood in the Age of AI

- The N + 1 Model: Artificial Intelligence and Metaphysical Limitations
  —Mihretu Guta, Biola University
- Digital Necromancy: Animating and Impersonating Photographed Life
  —Kevin Kambo, University of Dallas
- AI Afterlife
  —Melissa Schubert Johnson, Biola University

Greater Works? Ministry, Sanctification, and AI Tools

- SpiritSense: Leveraging AI for Sanctification
  —Ben Faus, First Baptist Church in Crawford, TX
- Greater Works Through Technology: Becoming All Things to All People in the Age of AI
  —Patrick Dailey, Ontario Community Church

Science, Writing, and the Liberal Arts in an AI Age

- Forming Scientists in the AI Age: Why the Liberal Arts in the Christian Intellectual Tradition are Indespensable
  —Alan Bradshaw, Lipscomb University
- The Person is the Product? How AI Exposes the Tension Between Process and Product in Undergraduate Writing
  —Michael West, University of Dallas
- AI Apocalypse: How Machines Can Drive Us to Recover Humane Learning
  —Andrew Brinkerhoff, Baylor University

Deploying AI with Integrity: Virtue, Truth, and Personhood

- Automating Truth? Human Integrity, Epistemic Justice, and the Moral Limits of AI Verification
  —Don Shin, Texas Tech University
- Mirror or Mirage? Generative AI, Personhood, and the Imago Dei in Reflective Interaction
  —Kendra Sumler, Campbell University
- Virtue as a Framework for AI Development and Use
  —Mitchell Neubert, Baylor University

Hospitality, Speech, and Power: AI and Cross-Cultural Communication

- Forming Hospitable Hearts Through AI: A Framework for Navigating AI Affordances for Developing Christian Cultural Intelligence
  —Suraj Sharma, Calvin University
  —Peter Snyder, Calvin University
  —Sophia Zhang, Baylor University
- In the Age of AI, Why Does Language Learning Matter?
  —Jill Cornish, Baylor University
- AI Translation and Lipsync in Theological Higher Education: Appropriate or Appropriating?
  —John Dyer, Dallas Theological Seminary
- Chair: Sophia Zhang

Subverting the Inhuman Temptations of AI: Cultivating Perseverance, Studiousness, and Wonder through Rereading

- Julie Ooms, Missouri Baptist University
- Rachel B. Griffis, Spring Arbor University
- Rachel M. De Smith Roberts, North Greenville University

Global Inequities in the Age of AI: Displacement, Corruption, and Technocracy

- How Can Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning Contribute to Preventing and Fighting Corruption from a Christian Perspective: Evidence from Brazil
  —Samuel Mamede, Taylor University
- AI, the Technocratic Economy, and the Global South
  —David Opderbeck, Seton Hall University
- Digital Discipleship and Sacred Authority: Biblical Frameworks for AI Stewardship in Global Christianity
  —Pamela Johnson, PYJDesigns Advisory Group

Techno-Utopian Imagination: Lessons for AI

- "That Hideous AI: Science as Dangerous in the Thoughts of C. S. Lewis and Neil Postman
  —Michael Stell, Redeemer Classical Christian School
- The Hideous Strength of our Times
  —Scott Masson, Tyndale University, Toronto, Canada
- Critiquing Transhumanism's Superhappiness Project: The Human Cost of Techno-Utopia
  —Julie Miller, Faulkner University

10:30 to 10:45 a.m.

Break

10:45 a.m. to 12:15 p.m.

Sessions (George W. Truett Theological Seminary)

AI and...Un-fleshing, Creativity, Community, Idolatry, and Work – University of Dallas Student Panel

- Imagination and Machine Learning: How LLMs Promote and Inhibit Creativity in STEM Education

—Isabella Brown, University of Dallas

- "Keep Your AI Close and Your Friends Closer: How AI Study Tools Weaken Academic Community and Decrease Learning"

—Cecilia Fojut, University of Dallas

- Sleep-talking and Dead Metaphors: Some (Idolatrous?) Consequences of AI-Generated Poetry on Language

—Katherine LeMaster, University of Dallas

- Respecting the Personhood of Workers in the AI Era

—Nathan Polzer, University of Dallas

- The Use of AI and the Un-Fleshing of Words

—Elena Weyant, University of Dallas

- Chair: Michael West, University of Dallas

Artificial Intelligence in Education, Social Media, and Among the Classical Liberal Arts – Tarleton State University Presidential Honors Program Students

- Anna Rasberry, Tarleton State University
- Katie Woods, Tarleton State University
- Stephanie Scott, Tarleton State University
- Josalyn Franell, Tarleton State University
- Chair: Karl Aho, Tarleton State University

Navigating Faithful Teaching in an AI Age: Ethical, Theological, and Inclusive Approaches to Classroom Innovation

- Hyesun Ro, Indiana Wesleyan University
- Denise Burkett, Indiana Wesleyan University
- Nenetzin Stoeckle, Indiana Wesleyan University
- Chair: Mitchell Neubert

Finding a Human Voice in AI-Supported Classrooms

- Developing Writing Voice with AI: Student Perspectives
  —Kelly Leavitt, University of Missouri-Columbia
- Comprehension and the Author-Reader Relationship: Using AI in Education to Make Texts Accessible to Students
  —Kevin Taylor, Ambleside Colorado (K–12 School)

Literature in the Age of AI

- What Can Romantic Poetry Teach Christian Artists and Educators About AI?
  —David Smith, University of Science and Arts of Oklahoma
- Divine Imagination or Mechanical Fancy? AI and the Arts in Light of S.T. Coleridge's Christian Romanticism
  —Luke Taylor, Boston College

Redemptive Reimagining of Christian K–12 Education

- Sustainable School Leadership in an Era of AI: The Authenticity of Green Spaces and Stewardship Principles
  —William Sterrett, Baylor University
  —Meredith Frey, Baylor University
- Redemptively Reimagining Christian K–12 Education in the Age of AI
  —Sean Riley, The Stony Brook School

Art, Soul, and AI

- Christopher Alexander, AI, and the Creative Process
  —Philip Tan, Messiah University
- Theatrical Projection Design with an AI Integrated Workflow: What is Lost and What is Gained
  —Ryan Joyner, Baylor University
- Transposing to a New Key: How the Music Theology of Maeve Heaney Can Help Us Navigate AI's Impact on the Arts
  —Phillip Ganir, Boston College

12:15 to 1:00 p.m.

Box Lunches (George W. Truett Theological Seminary, Paul and Katy Piper Great Hall)

1:00 to 2:30 p.m.

Final Remarks (Cashion 5th Floor)

- Elisabeth Rain Kincaid, Director of Institute for Faith and Learning

Live Recording of "No Small Endeavor" Podcast featuring Rosalind Picard (Cashion 5th Floor)

- Rosalind Picard, Massachusetts Institute of Technology
- Lee C. Camp, *No Small Endeavor*